

own *lack of understanding*. That's when the grim reality of the human condition is revealed—and it scares the living hell out of us.

Uncertainty is a state of mind. Certainty is a level of comfort—the unjustified belief that you know what will happen. You have a good sense of the future, so it is easy to plan for what comes next, *because* of the lack of uncertainty.

Of course, this is a false belief, a completely misguided fallacy inherent to the species.

Your lack of uncertainty only means that you feel pretty good—comfortable and unthreatened enough to casually lie to yourself about how much you imagine you know. You can pretend you can see what is coming because there is nothing to make you worry about it otherwise. When the stock market rallies, you are optimistic about the future. You can comfortably extrapolate from today out years or decades ahead.

This is, of course, utter bullshit.

You had no idea what was going to happen this year, and you have no idea what is going to happen next year. If you were comfortable last year, it was because nothing was rubbing your face in how little you actually knew about the future—not the market, not the economy, not geopolitics. Despite this, you keep making forecasts, regardless of overwhelming evidence that you are terrible at it.

You managed to somehow forget how little you knew about the future. When your limbic system is not overly stimulated, when you can relax a bit ... *deep inhale ... hold it ... deep exhale ... let it out ...* you can fool yourself into believing any form of nonsense. This is the normal state of human affairs.

The next time you hear someone mention *uncertainty*, ask yourself this: How much less do they actually know about the future today versus what they knew last week or year? How little do they *realize they don't know*?